MANOJ AHUJA
SECRETARY

भारत सरकार
कृषि एवं किसान कल्याण मंत्रालय
कृषि एवं किसान कल्याण विभाग
Government of India
Ministry of Agriculture & Farmers Welfare
Department of Agriculture & Farmers Welfare

Dated the 22nd June, 2022

Dear Chief Secretary,

I am writing to you with regard to the discussions held in the Conference of Chief Secretaries in Dharamshala on 16th and 17th of June, 2022 regarding creation of Agristack-Digital Agriculture. This will enable farmers to access services digitally and increase their returns from farming activities.

In the initial stage of setting up Agristack, three basic building blocks consisting of the following important IT systems/ databases will have to be put in place by the States:

1. Farmers database with dynamic linking of Land Records.
2. Geo referencing of Village Maps.
3. GIS Base Real Time Crop Survey.

You may also recall that a timeline of 31st March, 2023 has been fixed for the completion of the above three building blocks.

A Digital Agriculture Mission institutional framework has been put in place at DA&FW. A Joint Committee has been set up which is chaired by Mr. Rajeev Chawla, Former Additional Chief Secretary, Government of Karnataka, now working as Chief Knowledge Officer & Advisor, and having senior officers from DA& FW and DoLR. (Order issued on this regard is enclosed). This Unit will work closely with the State Governments and provide support and hand holding for completion of the three tasks.

DA&FW will also provide reference applications for farmers portal and for crop survey with the help of Government of Karnataka for customization and use. States would be however be at liberty to develop their own applications or to use existing applications, if any.

Creation of the three core building blocks for Agristat will require close coordination between different departments in the State, primarily the Revenue Department and the Agriculture Department. As was decided in the Chief Secretaries conference, there is a need to set up a Steering Committee and an Implementation Committee for taking the required policy decisions, monitoring of the implementation and ensuring coordination among departments.

It is, therefore, requested to set up two Committees, as per the suggestions given below:-

1. Steering Committee : To be chaired by Chief Secretary, the committee should have the Secretary Revenue, Secretary Agriculture, Secretary IT and Secretaries of other departments besides other members who will be related to this work, along with representation from Government of India. The Steering Committee may meet once in two months to review the progress of the work done in the State.

Office : Krishi Bhawan, New Delhi-110001, दूरभाष / Phone : 23382651, 23388444 फैक्स नं० / Fax No. : 2338600
E-mail : secy-agri@gov.in

Implementation Committee : This Committee will have Secretary Revenue, Secretary Agriculture, Director(IT)/Director/Commissioner(Land records), Director/Commissioner (Agriculture) and other officers, as per the requirements of the State as members, and could be co-chaired by the Secretary Agriculture & Secretary Revenue. States may finalise the Committees as per their requirements and needs. This committee would be responsible for day to day implementation of these three tasks and would meet at least once every month.

Keeping in view the strict timelines, it is requested that the two committees may be immediately constituted. It is also requested to send the proceedings of the meetings to DA&FW on a regular basis.

Looking forward to your cooperation & support.

With regards.

Yours faithfully.

(Manoj Ahuja)

Chief Secretary of All States/UTs.